

2022 Minerals Yearbook

TAJIKISTAN [ADVANCE RELEASE]

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World rankings for mineral production, shares of world production, and reserves presented in this chapter are derived from the referenced sources. Production data in this chapter may differ from data in other sources because of differences in the date of reporting.

THE MINERAL INDUSTRY OF TAJIKISTAN

By Karine M. Renaud

In 2022, aluminum, antimony, cement, coal, gold, gypsum, lead, mercury, natural gas, crude petroleum, salt, sand and gravel, silver, and zinc were produced in Tajikistan. In terms of world production in 2022, Tajikistan ranked second in antimony production and second in mercury production (excluding United States production) and accounted for 15% and 5% of world production, respectively (table 1; Klochko, 2024; Sheaffer, 2024).

Minerals in the National Economy

In 2022, Tajikistan's real gross domestic product (GDP) increased by 8.0% compared with an increase of 9.4% (revised) in 2021 owing to less financial disruption from the Russia-Ukraine conflict than was expected and a 51.8% increase in workers traveling to Russia for low-skilled jobs, which sustained financial inflows, including remittances. The nominal GDP was \$10.5 billion. Industrial production, in terms of value, decreased by 15.4% in 2022 as a result of a disruption in the supply chain. Within the industrial sector, manufacturing production, in terms of value, increased by 16.4%, whereas that of the mining sector decreased by 2.3%. The foreign direct investment was \$174 million in 2022 compared with \$84 million in 2021 (Asian Development Bank, 2023, p. 80; International Monetary Fund, 2023b, p. 147; United Nations Conference on Trade and Development, 2023, p. 198; World Bank, The, 2023).

In 2022, the value of Tajikistan's total exports was \$1.8 billion, which was a decrease of 17% compared with exports in 2021, and the value of total imports was \$5.1 billion, which was a decrease of 19% compared with imports in 2021. In 2022, exports of ore, slag, and ash increased to \$628 million from \$350 million in 2021. The country's main export partners for ore, slag, and ash in 2022 were Kazakhstan (which received 67% of Tajikistan's ore, slag, and ash exports) and China (32%). The value of exports of unwrought aluminum decreased to \$103 million in 2022 from \$170 million in 2021, and the country's main export partner for unwrought aluminum in 2022 was Turkey, which received 93% of Tajikistan's unwrought aluminum exports. The value of exports of antimony and articles thereof increased to \$118 million from \$103 million in 2021, and the country's main export partners for antimony and articles thereof (unwrought antimony, powder) in 2022 were France, which received 66% of Tajikistan's antimony and articles thereof [unwrought antimony, powder] exports, and Belgium, which received 27%. The value of exports of base metals and articles of base metal decreased to \$268 million from \$293 million in 2021, and the country's main export partners for base metals and articles of base metals were Turkey, which received 36% of these exports; France, 29%; Uzbekistan, 14%; and Belgium, 12% (International Monetary Fund, 2023a, p. 25; Zen Innovations AG, 2023).

In 2022, the value of imports of base metals and articles of base metal increased to \$939 million from \$635 million in 2021.

The main import partners for these exports were Iran, which supplied 47% of Tajikistan's imports; China, 35%; and Kazakhstan, 11%. Imports of ore, slag, and ash were valued at \$47,183 compared with a value of \$1.4 million in 2021, and the country's only import partner for them was China, which supplied 100% of Tajikistan's ore, slag, and ash imports. The value of imports of ecaussine, marble, travertine, and other calcareous monumental or building stone of an apparent specific gravity of at least 2.5 decreased to \$647,896 from \$1.1 million in 2021, and the country's main import partners for ecaussine, marble, travertine, and other calcareous monumental or building stone of an apparent specific gravity of at least 2.5 were Uzbekistan, which supplied 76% of Tajikistan's imports; and Iran, 24%. Imports of cement increased to \$6.5 million from \$1.7 million in 2021, and the main cement import partner was Iran, which supplied 99% of Tajikistan's imports (Zen Innovations AG, 2023).

Government Policies and Programs

As of November 27, 2019, the Government allowed private individuals to conduct artisanal mining of placer deposits for extraction of antimony, fluorite, gold, platinum, precious and semiprecious stones, rare earths, silver, tin, titanium, tungsten, and other minerals. To extract these minerals, individuals must obtain permitting documents from the Ministry of Finance, which allows those with permits to conduct alluvial mining in areas with undetermined reserves and resources. The Government of Tajikistan's Main Directorate of Geology determines the valleys and tributaries of rivers and the talus of mountain slopes on which individuals may extract minerals. In addition, the holders of permits are obligated to sell mined precious stones and metals to the state depository of valuables under the Ministry of Finance (CentralAsia.media, 2019).

The National Development Strategy of the Republic of Tajikistan for 2030, which was first announced in 2015, is aimed at improving socioeconomic resources, increasing industrial development, and determining the path for the future development of the country through integration of modern technologies at all levels of international and regional organizations. Implementation of the strategy was facing challenges owing to the negative effects of worldwide crises, especially the coronavirus disease 2019 (COVID-19) pandemic and changes in the priorities of development partners. The finances raised through various investments were largely being directed to alleviating the consequences of the COVID-19 pandemic (Agency of Social Insurance and Pension under the Government of the Republic of Tajikistan, 2016, p. 2–5; Embassy of the Republic of Tajikistan in the Republic of Korea, 2019; Chorshanbiyev, 2024).

The Law on Precious Metals and Gemstones of May 12, 2001, No. 21, which was amended on November 27, 2014, is the

law that regulates exploration for and production of precious metals and gemstones. The Law on Production Sharing Agreements of March 5, 2007, No. 238, which was amended on August 1, 2012, is the law that regulates foreign investment in the exploration, transportation, processing, storage, usage, and trade of minerals between the state and investors when signing and terminating a production-sharing agreement. The Law on Subsoil of July 20, 1994, No. 983, which was amended on December 28, 2013, is the law that outlines and strengthens (1) the use of the subsoil to protect the interests of Tajikistan and its natural resources, (2) the rational use and protection of the subsoil of Tajikistan, (3) the interests of subsoil users, (4) the conditions for the development of all forms of economic activity, and (5) the rule of law in subsoil use (SojuzPravoInform LLC, 2020a–c).

Production

In 2022, production of zinc ore (gross weight) and zinc ore (Zn content) decreased by 16% each, and production of mercury ore (Hg content) decreased by 15%. In 2022, the production of mined gold (Au content) increased by 47%; bituminous coal and lignite (estimated), by 26% each; antimony ore (gross weight and Sb content), by 25% each; and natural gas, by 11%. The increase in coal production was in response to an increase in coal demand in domestic and industrial areas, and an increase in exports (Sputnik, 2023). Data on mineral production are in table 1.

Structure of the Mineral Industry

Table 2 is a list of major mineral industry facilities.

Commodity Review

Metals

Aluminum.—In 2022, state-owned OJSC Tajik Aluminum Co. (TALCO) remained the sole producer of aluminum in Tajikistan; its production increased by 2% to 62,000 metric tons (t) of aluminum from 61,000 t in 2021. Production for 2022 had been projected to increase to 120,000 t; however, owing to old equipment and supply chain interruptions for raw materials and necessary components from China, production increased only to 62,000 t. On June 15, 2019, an agreement was signed between the Government and China Machinery Engineering Corp. (CMEC) of China for the modernization of TALCO. According to the agreement, the modernization cost was estimated to be \$545 million and would result in a plant capacity increase to 300,000 metric tons per year (t/yr) of aluminum by 2027 (tables 1, 2; Radio Ozodi, 2019; CAG, 2021; Chorschanbiyev, 2023; Eastwest Stream, 2023; Financial One, 2023).

Antimony and Gold.—In 2022, Tajikistan's production of gold increased to 11,907 kilograms (kg) from 8,079 kg in 2021. Tajikistan's antimony (Sb content) production increased by 25% to 21,000 t from 16,777 t in 2021. Gold producers in Tajikistan in 2022 were JV Aprelevka, Arteli Odina, China Nonferrous Gold Ltd. (CNG) of China, Darvaz LLC, JV Zarafshon Gold Co. LLC [70% owner of Zarafshon (for the Jilau and Taror gold mines)], Tilloi Tojik, Takom Gold LLP, and artisanal miners (tables 1, 2).

In 2022, JV Zarafshon Gold Co. LLC produced 6,456 kg of gold from the Jilau and Taror Mines. CNG operated the Pakrut gold mine through its wholly owned subsidiary LLC Pakrut. The Pakrut Mine produced 1,451 kg of gold (China Nonferrous Gold Ltd., 2022, p. 6; Zijin Mining Group Co. Ltd., 2022, p. 36).

In 2022, the President launched the TALCO Gold CJSC (TALCO Gold) mine and processing plant in Ayni District, Sughd Province, which had a production capacity of 2,000 kilograms per year of gold and 3,000 t/yr of antimony. TALCO Gold was the joint-stock company made up of Huayu Tibet Mining Co. of China (50%) and TALCO (50%). In April, the President signed a decree that would allow TALCO to transfer a 25-year license to TALCO Gold to develop mineral resources in the Konchoch area. The Konchoch area contained three deposits: the Chulboy gold-silver deposit, the Konchoch gold-silver-mercury-fluorite deposit, and the Shakhkon gold-antimony-arsenic-fluorite deposit. The mineral reserves in the Konchoch deposit were estimated to be 265,000 t of antimony, 76,000 t of fluorite, 1,197 t of mercury, 50 t of gold, and 59 t of silver (Nadirov, 2019; Sputnik, 2019; Thomson Reuters, 2020; Asia-Plus, 2021; EurAsia Daily, 2022).

Industrial Minerals

Fluorite.—Vast Resources plc (Vast Resources) of the United Kingdom held 24.5% interest in a joint-venture project with OJSC Korkhonai Boygardonii Takob Co. (Takob). Takob was 100% owned by TALCO, which operated the Takob fluorite and galena mine. Vast Resources obtained interest in the project through its 49% interest in Central Asia Investments Ltd., which in turn held a 50% interest in CAMM Central Asia Minerals and Metals Ore Trading FZCO (CAMM). Under an agreement between CAMM and Takob, CAMM was to provide technology and equipment to upgrade the processing plant at the Takob mining complex, including managing the project; it would also provide other services, including marketing and sales. The mine was projected to produce 7,000 metric tons per month [2.5 million metric tons per year] of ore containing 27% fluoride, and between 1.5% and 2% lead and 1.2% to 1.4% zinc. The updated Takob smelter was opened on August 15, 2022 [Novosti Tajikistana, 2022; OJSC Tajik Aluminum Co. (TALCO), 2022, p. 7–8; Vast Resources Plc, 2022, p. 2–3, 8; 2023a, b].

Outlook

Tajikistan continued to rely heavily on foreign investment and loans for infrastructure development and mineral enterprises. In 2022, foreign companies (mainly from China) continued to be engaged in the production of aluminum, gold, lead, and zinc in the country, and they are expected to continue to increase existing production and to invest in new production projects of these commodities in coming years. Tajikistan is planning to increase aluminum production by completing the modernization of an aluminum smelter in the western town of Tursunzoda and a new mining and processing plant in the Konchoch area.

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TABLE 1
TAJIKISTAN: PRODUCTION OF MINERAL COMMODITIES¹

(Metric tons, gross weight, unless otherwise specified)

Commodity ²	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022
METALS					
Aluminum, metal, primary	95,796	101,000	84,000	61,000	62,000
Antimony, mine, ore:					
Gross weight	64,280	67,000	89,000	71,000	89,000
Sb content	15,240	16,000	21,000	16,777	21,000
Gold, mine, Au content kilograms	6,400	8,100	7,595	8,079	11,907
Lead, refinery, concentrate:					
Gross weight	99,000	144,000	91,000	80,000	79,000
Pb content	59,300	86,771	54,863	48,058	47,510
Mercury, mine, Hg content	100	91	178	117 ^c	100 ^c
Silver, mine, Ag content kilograms	6,300 ^c	10,800	11,600	11,100	12,000 ^c
Zinc, mine, concentrate:					
Gross weight	166,461	156,417	94,190	142,000	119,000 ^c
Zn content	83,000	78,200	48,400	70,573	59,100
INDUSTRIAL MINERALS					
Cement, hydraulic thousand metric tons	3,844	4,202	4,243	4,200 ^r	4,000
Gypsum, mine	9,639	10,031	8,183	7,800	8,000 ^c
Salt	36,964	35,496	37,023	37,023 ^r	37,000 ^c
Sand and gravel, construction ^c	3,411,000 ^r	2,470,000	2,330,000	2,400,000	2,500,000
MINERAL FUELS AND RELATED MATERIALS					
Coal:					
Bituminous	1,838,065	1,963,827	1,951,200	2,070,000 ^c	2,600,000
Lignite	68,990	63,963	77,939	86,000 ^c	108,000 ^c
Natural gas thousand cubic meters	1,623	730	678	762	848
Petroleum, crude ³ thousand 42-gallon barrels	175 ^c	170 ^c	179 ^r	181 ^c	183 ^c

^cEstimated. ^rRevised.

¹Table includes data available through July 26, 2023. All data are reported unless otherwise noted. Estimated data are rounded to no more than three significant digits.

²In addition to the commodities listed, clay, fluorite, and stone (dolomite, limestone, and marble) may have been produced, but available information was inadequate to make reliable estimates of output.

³The production of crude petroleum was reported in metric tons.

TABLE 2
TAJIKISTAN: STRUCTURE OF THE MINERAL INDUSTRY IN 2022¹

(Thousand metric tons unless otherwise specified)

Commodity	Major operating companies, main facilities, or deposits	Location of main facilities	Annual capacity ^e
Aluminum	OJSC Tajik Aluminum Co. (TALCO) (Government, 100%)	Tursunzoda (Regar) smelter, Tursunzoda city, Districts of Republican Subordination	100
Antimony:			
Ore, gross weight	Anzob LLC (Government, 51%, and Comsup Commodities Inc., 49%)	Jijikrut Mine at Anzob mining- beneficiation complex, Ayni, Sughd Province	64
Concentrate, Sb content	OJSC Tajik Aluminum Co. (TALCO) (Government, 100%), 50%, and Huayu Tibet Mining Co., 50%	Konchoch area, Ayni, Sughd Province	3
Sb content of ore	JSC Tamokhush (Government, 100%)	JSC Tamokhush-Isfara hydrometallurgical plant, Sughd Province	15
Cement	Chzhungtsai Mohir Cement Co. and Government	Plant at Yovon District, Khatlon Province	1,200
Do.	do.	Plant at Jalolidinni Balkhi District, Khatlon Province	600
Do.	Huaxin Gayur Cement Co. Ltd., 75%, and Gayur LLC, 25%	Chjuntsay-Taboshar plant at Istiqlol, Sughd Province	600
Do.	do.	Plant at Yovon, Yovon District, Khatlon Province	1,200
Do.	JSC Tajikcement Ltd.	Plant at Dushanbe	1,100
Do.	Tajik Ghayur Co. and Huaxin Central Asia Investment	Ghayur-Sughd plant at Ghafurov District, Sughd Province	1,000
Do.	Toj-China cement plant, JV Tajikistan-China Co.	Plant at Vahdat District	500
Clay, loam	do.	Varzobskoye Ushchel'ye deposit in Varzob District	NA
Coal	Isfara hydrometallurgical plant (Government, 100%)	Plant at Isfara, Sughd Province	300
Do.	Kaisun Energy Group Ltd.	Fan-Yaghnob Mine, Pyandzh, Khatlon Province	50
Do.	OJSC Angisht	Mine, Sughd Province	32
Do.	do.	Brown coal deposit, Sughd Province	23
Do.	SP Anzob	do.	NA
Fluorite:			
Mine, gross weight	OJSC Korkhonai Boygardonii Takob Co. [OJSC Tajik Aluminum Co. (TALCO) (Government, 100%)]	Takob Mine, Districts of Republican Subordination	2
Concentrate	do.	Takob smelter, Districts of Republican Subordination	80
Galena	do.	Takob Mine, Districts of Republican Subordination	NA
Gold:			
Ore, Au content	Arteli Odina	Mine at Shugnov Khovaling, Khatlon Province	NA
Do.	Artisanal miners	NA	NA
Do.	kilograms Darvaz LLC (Government, 51%, and Gold and Mineral Excavation Co., 49%)	Yak-Suyskoye deposit, Khatlon Province	400
Do.	do. LLC Pakrut [China Nonferrous Gold Ltd. (CNG), 100%]	Pakrut gold mine, 120 kilometers northeast of Dushanbe	1,500
Do.	do. JV Aprelevka (Government, 51%, and Central Asia Minerals and Resources through subsidiary Gulf International Minerals Ltd., 49%)	Aprelevka deposit, Asht District, Sughd Province	600
Do.	do. JV Zarafshon Gold Co. LLC [Zijin Mining Group Co. Ltd. (ZGC), 70%, and Government, 30%]	Jilau and Taror mines, Zarafshon valley, Sughd Province	6,000
Do.	Takom Gold LLP	NA	NA
Do.	Tilloi Tojik (Government, 100%)	Yakhsou deposit, Khatlon Province	NA

See footnotes at the end of table

TABLE 2—Continued
TAJIKISTAN: STRUCTURE OF THE MINERAL INDUSTRY IN 2022¹

(Thousand metric tons unless otherwise specified)

Commodity		Major operating companies, main facilities, or deposits	Location of main facilities	Annual capacity ^e
Gold:—Continued				
Ore processing		Kansayskoye mining complex	Aprelevka plant, Burgunda, Sughd Province	NA
Concentrate, Au content	kilograms	OJSC Tajik Aluminum Co. (TALCO) (Government, 100%), 50%, and Huayu Tibet Mining Co., 50%	Konchoch area, Ayni, Sughd Province	2
Do.		Vostokredmet refinery	Refinery in Qizfaquz, Sughd Province	NA
Lead-zinc		Adrasman mining-beneficiation complex (Government, 100%)	Mine in Adrasman, Sughd Province	NA
Do.		Kansayskoye mining complex	Mine in Karamazor, Sughd Province	NA
Do.		Tajik-China Mining Co. Ltd.	Zarnisor Shimoli Mine, Northern Altyn-Topkan and Pay-Buloq, Sughd Province	NA
Do.		Takaelyskiy metallurgical complex	NA	NA
Do.		Tibet Summit Industry Co.	Mine in Altyn-Topkan, Sughd Province	NA
Concentrate		OJSC Korkhonai Boygardonii Takob Co. [OJSC Tajik Aluminum Co. (TALCO) (Government, 100%)]	Takob mining-beneficiation combine, Nohiyahoi Tobei Jumhuri	88
Mercury, Hg content	metric tons	Anzob mining-beneficiation complex (Comsup Commodities Inc., 100%)	Jijikrut Mine, central Tajikistan	100
Petroleum:				
Crude	thousand 42-gallon barrels	Beshtentyakskoye, Kichik-Belskoye, Shaambary, and Uzunkhorskoye deposits	Southern Tajik depression, southern Tajikistan	250
Refined	do.	OJSC Nafrason	Refinery Kanibadam city, Sughd Province	500
Do.	do.	NA	Refinery in Turshzoda town, Shahrinav District	460
Salt		NA	Ashtskiy plant, Kamyshkurganskoye deposit, Asht District, Sugd Province	NA
Do.		NA	Khoja-Sartez, Samanchi, and Tanabchi deposits, Vose District, Khatlon Province	NA
Do.		Voseyskiy plant	Voseyskiy plant, Khodzha-Muminskoye deposit, Khatlon Province	NA
Sand and gravel		Anvar LLC	NA	58
Silver, mine, Ag content		Adrasman mining-beneficiation complex (Government, 100%)	Mine in Adrasman, Sughd Province	NA
Do.		Nukrafom Co. (Silverhill Resources Ltd.)	Kanjol Mine, Gafurov District, Sughd Province	NA
Do.		JV Aprelevka (Government, 51%, and Central Asia Minerals and Resources through subsidiary Gulf International Minerals Ltd., 49%)	Aprelevka deposit, Asht District, Sughd Province	NA
Do.	kilograms	JV Zarafshon Gold Co. LLC [Zijin Mining Group Co. Ltd. (ZGC), 70%, and Government, 30%]	Jilau-Taror Mine, Sughd Province	4,000
Stone:				
Marble		Dal'yan Bolo deposit	Ghonchi, Devashtich District, Sughd Province	NA
Do.		Dashtak deposit	Darvoz District	NA
Do.		Jilikul deposit	Panjakent District, Sughd Province	NA
Limestone		JSC Tajikcement Ltd.	Kharangonskoye deposit, Varzob District	NA

^eEstimated; estimated data are rounded to no more than three significant digits. Do., do. Ditto. NA Not available.

¹Many location names have changed since the breakup of the Soviet Union. Many enterprises, however, are still named or commonly referred to based on the former location name, which accounts for discrepancies in the names of enterprises and those of locations.